

New & Notable

Video iPod

Slim, Stunning, Sexy

Apple's latest, its a bit wider than the original iPod, because of the larger screen and smaller scroll wheel. The new model has been beaten down to look slimmer and smarter.

The most desirable feature of this iPod is that it plays video. What formats? Apple specifies H.264 video in 320 x 240 at 30 fps and MPEG-4 video in 480 x 480 at 30 fps. Audio can be encoded in AAC-LC up to 160 Kbps at 48 kHz. One good thing is that the new QuickTime has an "Export to iPod" option, which automatically takes care of these specifications.

During our test, the video playback was crisp, clear and enjoyable. Since the standard bundle doesn't include the AV cable, we were unable to connect it to a TV set. The device provides about 11 hours of battery life! Some nifty new apps have trickled into the iPod Video—a world clock, a great stopwatch and a superb-looking screen lock. But Apple has cut some corners—there's no A/C wall charger, AV cable or dock. Our verdict? The Video iPod makes for a great personal video player—if you can cough up the money.



Company **Apple Computer International**
Price **Rs 15,000 (30 GB)**
Phone **1600-4254683**
E-mail indiainfo@asia.apple.com
Web site www.apple.com

Rating



MSI MEGA 533 MP3 Player



Feature-Full

MSI has just launched a Flash-based MP3 (and WMA) player—the MEGA PLAYER 533 SD. The clincher is the SD (Secure Digital) card reader—you only need to insert the card to start playing songs from it! It has its own 256 MB of internal memory, accessible from a PC via USB. The player can also be used as a portable USB device; it can also function as an SD card reader for your PC!

You can record FM—or a speech—directly to memory! There is also a graphic equaliser. The build quality of the casing is a let-down, and the earphones seemed a little uncomfortable and oversized. The AAA alkaline cell lasted for about eight hours, as claimed. For the price, this is not a bad buy at all!

Company **Micro Star International**
Price **Rs 2,700 (estimated)**
Phone **011-41758808**
E-mail info@msi-india.com
Web site <http://www.msi.com.tw>

Rating



Lexmark P4350 All-in-One

Pretty But Pricey

The P4350 All-in-One is an inkjet photo MFD. It uses a dual-cartridge system for photo-quality printing, and the colour scanner is an A4 flatbed. This is a good thing, because a sheet-fed scanner could very well crumple your photos while you're scanning them!

MFDs do not have to look boring, and the P4350 proves it. It sports sleek, elegant looks and blue LEDs all over the place that would make any printer, let alone an MFD, turn green with envy.

The P4350 supports almost all memory card standards, and also PictBridge. So you can just click away with your digital camera, insert the memory card into the MFD, preview your photos on the 1.7-inch colour LCD screen, and just press a button to print your photos!

The Lexmark Imaging Studio—a photo editor, and the ABBYY FineReader 6 Sprint OCR software, make this a complete package. Overall performance, however, was a bit slow, and print quality was just about average. At Rs 15,999, the Lexmark P4350 All-in-One is still out of reach for most home users.

Company **Lexmark International (India) Pvt Ltd**
Price **Rs 15,999**
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Rating

